



What is a plant?

Plants come in all shapes and sizes—from tiny green mosses to giant trees—but almost all plants contain a green pigment called chlorophyll. This chemical harnesses the energy of sunlight to make the food (a sugar called glucose) that the plant needs to grow. As part of this process, called photosynthesis, plants take carbon dioxide gas from the air and turn it into food, while releasing oxygen, which all animals need to breathe.

Flower ➤ This colorful part of the plant contains the male and female cells that are responsible for producing seeds.

Tendrils ➤ This plant has a special stem, called a tendril, which wraps around nearby objects, helping support the plant.

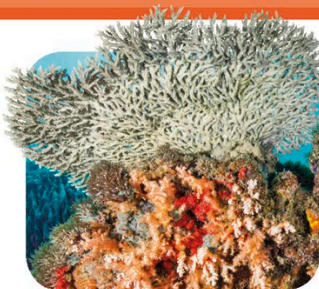


Not a plant



Lichens

A lichen is made up of algae and fungi living together. The algae help make food, while the fungi provide shade.



Corals

Corals are tiny, underwater animals with hard skeletons. To grow, they depend on algae in their tissues to make energy from sunlight.



Algae

Many algae are green, like plants, but do not have true roots, stems, and leaves. Algae can live only in water.



Fungi

Unlike plants, fungi get their food from the soil, or from other plants and animals on which they grow.